

EU Ports Strategy

Boosting the competitiveness,
security and sustainability
of European ports

March 2026



EU ports facilitate:

74% of the EU's external trade
30% of intra-EU freight

EU ports handle:

3.4 billion tonnes of goods
~395 million passengers annually

The Strategy supports EU ports by

Strengthening competitiveness, innovation and digitalisation.

Establishing **guiding principles for EU funding & investments in third-country ports**, developing **guidance on foreign ownership of EU ports**, and promoting **innovation**.

Protecting and securing ports.

Combatting **drug trafficking & emerging threats**, port worker **background checks** & third-country **port assessments**, sharing **cybersecurity best practices**, & conducting an EU-wide security risk assessment.

Advancing the energy transition, sustainability and clean industries.

Taking measures to promote **electrification & improved grid connection**. Setting out a **new roadmap for competitive small and medium-sized ports**.

Promoting social cohesion, skills and quality jobs.

Supporting **small & medium-sized ports** by promoting innovation, clean energy, security & connectivity, developing a **skilled workforce** & providing guidance on **maritime safety** & alternative fuels.

Facilitating access to finance and investment.

Clearer & more **coordinated funding principles** while facilitating access to advisory services & de-risking tools, with particular attention to the needs of small & medium-sized ports.





550 ports connecting Europe and beyond*

*Ports on the TEN-T Network



327
Maritime ports



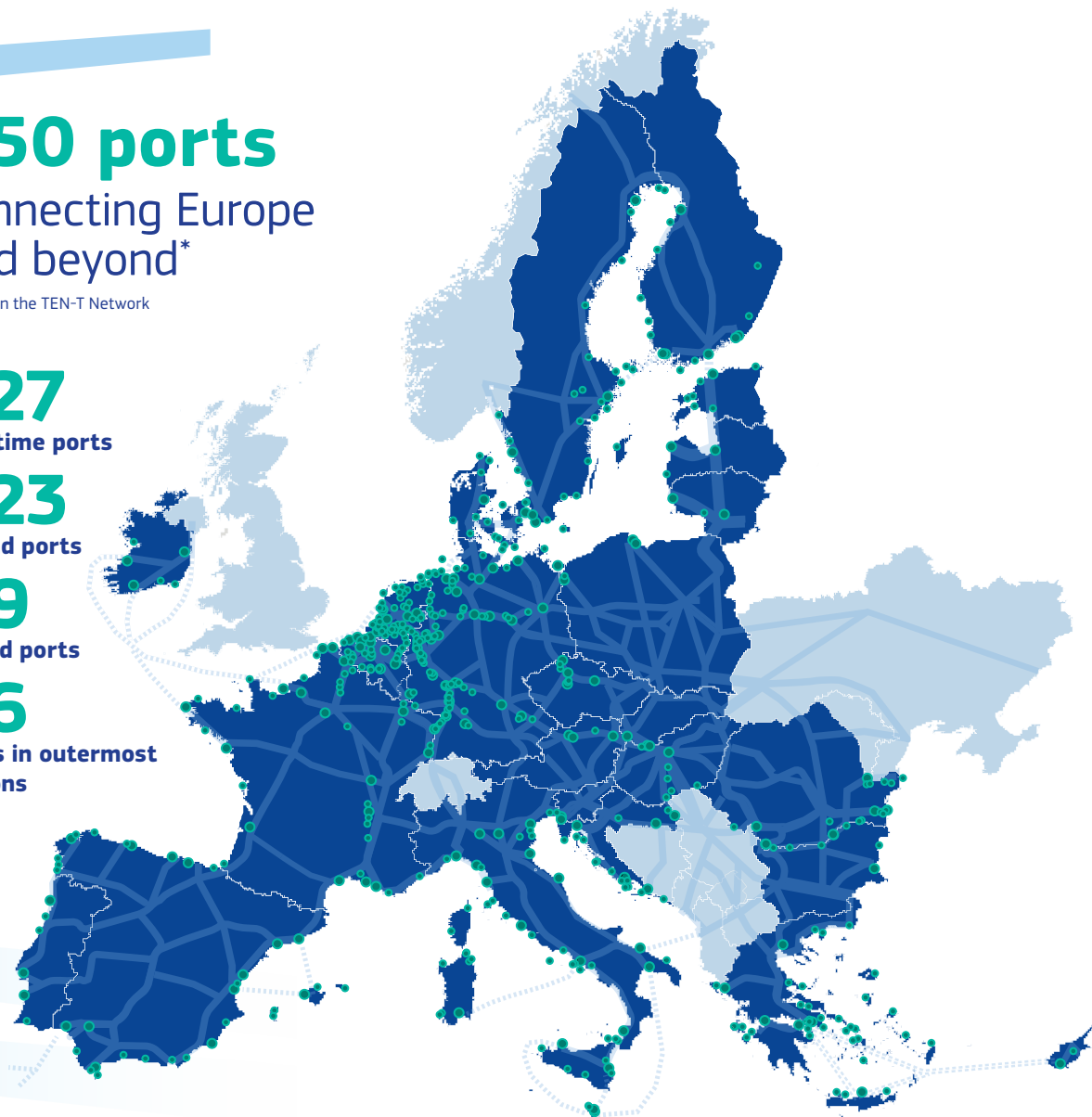
223
Inland ports



99
Island ports



26
Ports in outermost
regions



St. Martin (FR)



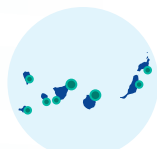
Mayotte (FR)



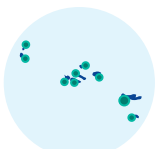
Guadeloupe Martinique (FR)



Réunion (FR)



Canary Islands (ES)



Azores (PT)



Madeira (PT)



Guiana (FR)

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